🎵 5: Weekly Review and Practice

🛠️ **Practical (2 hours):** Set up a basic AD environment with user accounts, GPOs, and shared resources.

📌 **Task:** Submit a report summarizing the setup with screenshots and configurations.

🎯 **Checkpoint:**

- Quiz: Active Directory concepts, GPOs, and file sharing.
- Practical Evaluation: Configure AD with GPOs and shared folders.

✅ Tasks

1.

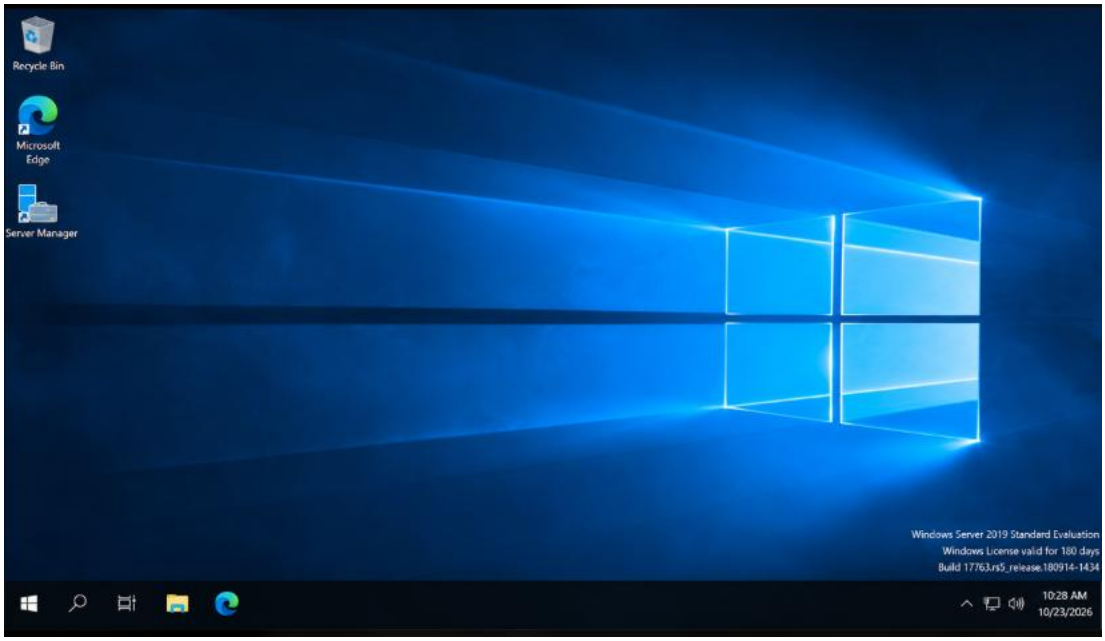
Install Windows Server (any version) on a virtual machine using VirtualBox or VMware, and take a screenshot of the successful installation desktop.

📝 **Answer:**

Steps:

1. Open VMware Workstation or VirtualBox.
2. Create a new virtual machine.
3. Select the Windows Server ISO file.
4. Assign RAM, CPU, and disk space.
5. Start the VM and install Windows Server.
6. Set the Administrator password.
7. Log in and open the desktop.

📸 **Screenshot :** Windows Server desktop after successful installation.



🎯 **Result:** Windows Server was successfully installed on a virtual machine.

2.

Create a new Active Directory domain called "musicstream.local" and add two user accounts: one for 'arijit.singh' and one for 'neha.kakkar'. Capture screenshots of the AD Users and Computers console showing both accounts.

📝 **Answer:**

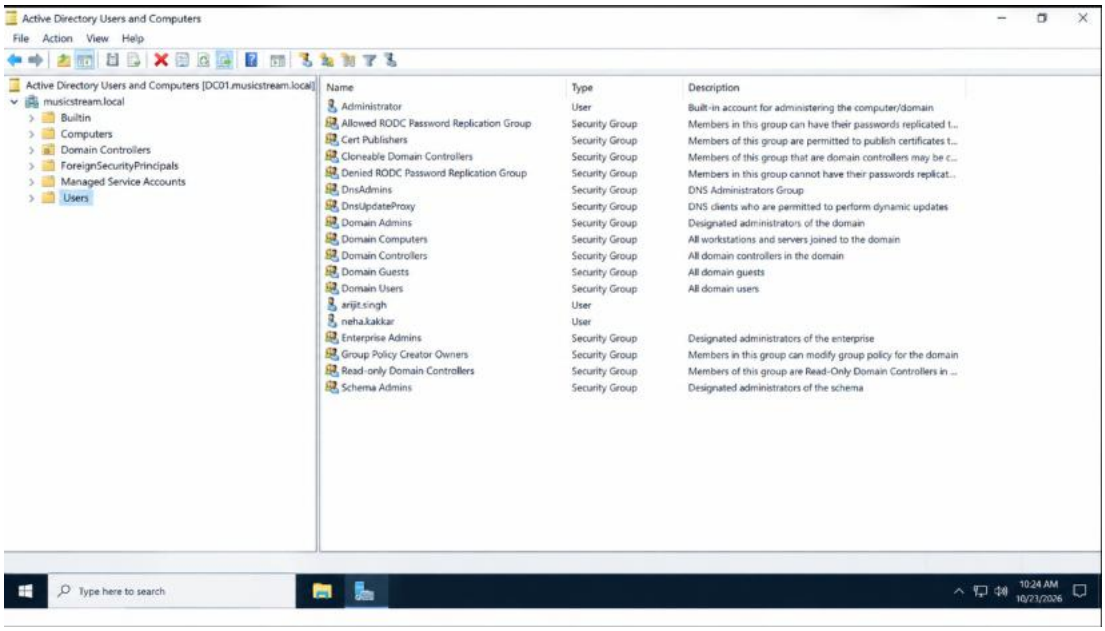
Steps to create the domain:

1. Open **Server Manager → Add Roles and Features**.
2. Install **Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS)**.
3. Click the notification flag and select **Promote this server to a domain controller**.
4. Select **Add a new forest**.
5. Enter `musicstream.local` as the root domain name.
6. Keep DNS Server and Global Catalog selected.
7. Set a DSRM password and complete the wizard.
8. Click **Install** and allow the server to restart.

Steps to create users:

1. Open **Server Manager → Tools → Active Directory Users and Computers**.
2. Expand `musicstream.local`.
3. Right-click the **Users** container and select **New → User**.
4. Create the first user with username `arijit.singh`.
5. Repeat the steps to create `neha.kakkar`.
6. Set a strong password for each user and finish the wizard.

📸 **Screenshot :** AD Users and Computers showing both user accounts.



🎯 **Result:** The `musicstream.local` domain and both user accounts were created successfully.

3.

Set up a Group Policy Object (GPO) that prevents users from accessing Control Panel, and link it to the 'Users' OU you created. Show before-and-after screenshots of the policy in effect for one of your test users.

📝 **Answer:**

Steps:

1. Open **Server Manager → Tools → Group Policy Management**.
2. Right-click the domain and select **New → Organizational Unit**.
3. Name the OU `Users` and click OK.
4. Move the test user account into this OU.
5. Right-click the `Users` OU and select **Create a GPO in this domain, and Link it here**.
6. Name the GPO `ControlPanelRestriction`.
7. Right-click the GPO and select **Edit**.
8. Navigate to:

   ```
   User Configuration → Policies → Administrative Templates → Control Panel
   ```

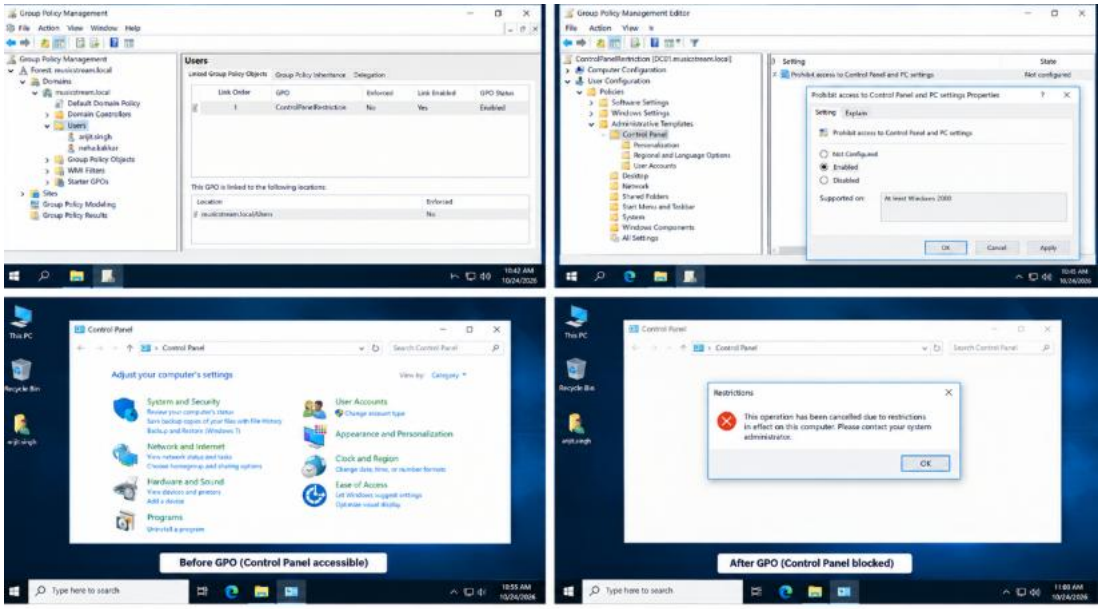
9. Open **Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings**.
10. Select **Enabled**, then click **Apply → OK**.

11. Log in as the test user and run:

```
gpupdate /force
```

12. Sign out and sign in again, then try to open Control Panel.

📸 **Screenshot :** Control Panel accessible before the policy is applied -- Control Panel blocked after the policy is applied.



🎯 **Result:** The GPO restricts the targeted user's access to Control Panel and PC settings.

4.

Share a folder named 'Playlists' on your Windows Server so that only the 'arijit.singh' user can read and write files, but 'neha.kakkar' can only read. Demonstrate this by logging in as each user and attempting to create or edit a file in the shared folder.

Hint: Use NTFS permissions and sharing settings to control access for each user.

📝 **Answer:**

Steps:

1. Open File Explorer and create a folder named `Playlists` on the server.
2. Right-click the folder and select **Properties**.
3. Open the **Sharing** tab and click **Advanced Sharing**.
4. Tick **Share this folder** and set the share name to `Playlists`.
5. Click **Permissions**.
6. Remove `Everyone` if present.

7. Add `arijit.singh` and `neha.kakkar`.
8. Allow both users **Read** at the share level.
9. Open the **Security** tab and click **Edit**.
10. Add `arijit.singh` and allow **Modify**.
11. Add `neha.kakkar` and allow **Read & execute**, **List folder contents**, and **Read** only.
12. Click **Apply → OK**.

Testing Arijit Singh:

1. Log in using `arijit.singh`.
2. Open the shared folder using `\\ServerName\Playlists`.
3. Create a file and edit it.

✅ **Expected result:** Arijit can create and edit files because his NTFS permissions allow Modify and the share permits access.

Testing Neha Kakkar:

1. Log in using `neha.kakkar`.
2. Open the same shared folder.
3. Try to open a file, then create or edit a file.

✅ **Expected result:** Neha can read files, but cannot create or edit them because her NTFS permissions are read-only.

🎯 **Result:** The `Playlists` folder is shared with different access permissions for both users.

5.

Write a short report (1-2 pages) summarizing your domain, user, GPO, and shared folder setup. Include at least 3 screenshots and describe one challenge you faced and how you solved it.

📝 **Answer:**

📄 Practical Report: Active Directory, GPO and File Sharing

1. Introduction

The objective of this practical was to configure a basic Windows Server environment using Active Directory, user accounts, Group Policy, and shared folders.

2. Domain and User Configuration

I installed Windows Server on a virtual machine and configured the Active Directory domain `musicstream.local`. I created two domain user accounts: `arijit.singh` and `neha.kakkar`.

3. Group Policy Configuration

I created a GPO named `ControlPanelRestriction` and linked it to the `Users` OU. I enabled the policy **Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings** to prevent the targeted user from changing system settings.

4. Shared Folder Configuration

I created a shared folder named `Playlists`. The user `arijit.singh` was given read and write access, while `neha.kakkar` was given read-only access. I configured NTFS and share permissions and tested both accounts.

5. Challenge Faced and Solution

Challenge: A user may be unable to create or edit files if the required share or NTFS permissions are missing.

Solution: I checked the Sharing and Security tabs, corrected the permissions for each user, and tested access again.

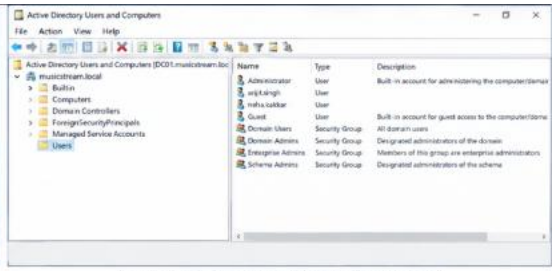
6. Conclusion

This practical helped me understand how to create an Active Directory domain, manage users, apply Group Policy, and configure shared folders with different permissions. These skills are useful for managing users and resources in an organization.

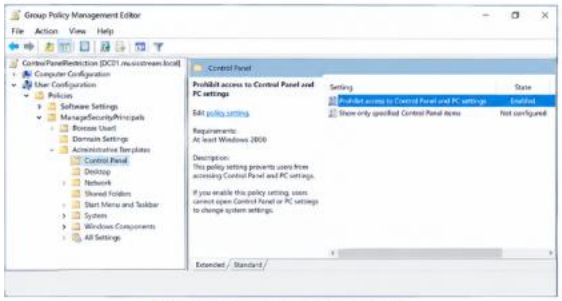
📸 Screenshots



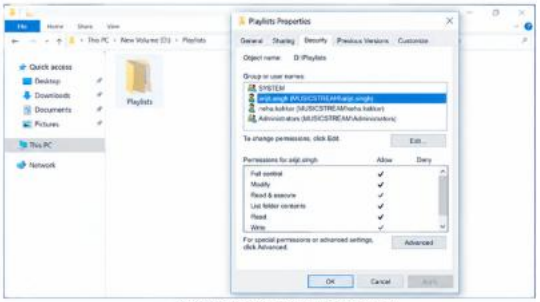
Screenshot 1: Windows Server Desktop (After Installation)



Screenshot 2: Active Directory Users and Computers (Domain and Users)



Screenshot 3: GPO Policy Enabled (Control Panel Restriction)



Screenshot 4: Shared Folder Permissions (Playlists)

1. Windows Server desktop.
2. AD Users and Computers showing both users.
3. Control Panel restriction or shared folder permissions.